

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 543

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to recognize Human Trafficking Awareness
Month, January 2026.

WHEREAS, human trafficking is defined as the recruitment, manipulation, purchasing, or obtaining of a person for the purpose of commercial sex acts or forced labor through the use of force, fraud, deception, or coercion; and

WHEREAS, human trafficking victims can be of any age, sex, race, or background, with particularly vulnerable populations, including children, survivors of child abuse, runaway and homeless youth, victims of interpersonal and intimate partner violence, individuals struggling with substance use disorders, and those impacted by conflict, poverty, or the failure of systems meant to support community members in their time of need; and

WHEREAS, human trafficking encompasses prostitution, escorting, online advertisements, digital platforms, and all forms of commercial sexual exploitation; and

WHEREAS, the existence of human trafficking in today's society recognizes that, for many, the perceived "choice" to sell one's body arises from a lack of safer, more accessible, and dignified options and resources; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee is home to several organizations that provide direct support services and advocate on behalf of survivors of human trafficking, prostitution, and commercial sexual exploitation; and

WHEREAS, the office of the Tennessee Secretary of State launched the Tennessee Businesses Against Trafficking Program, making it a statewide priority to educate Tennessee business owners on the signs of human trafficking; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Bureau of Investigation is required to submit an annual report on child and human trafficking crimes and trends; and

WHEREAS, human trafficking robs victims of their safety, freedom, and dignity; tears apart families and communities; fuels interpersonal violence; and undermines the security of society at large; and

WHEREAS, Human Trafficking Awareness Month is a month dedicated to promoting education, awareness, resources, and community efforts that will equip Tennesseans with the tools to identify and address human trafficking, support survivors, prevent exploitation, and hold perpetrators accountable; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize Human Trafficking Awareness Month, January 2026.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.